Empathize and Define

Deep Dive into Empathize & Define

- Stages of UX Design Thinking
- UX Research & User Personas
- UX Research
- Empathy Map
- User Persona
- Define

Stages of UX Design Thinking

UX Research & User Personas

Understanding users before designing for them

What is UX Research?

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UX Research is the process of understanding real users:

- What they do
- What they want
- What frustrates them

Example

- While redesigning an e-learning app, you discover students struggle to focus due to too many notifications.
- Unearthed notification from Apps.

Types of UX Research

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- Qualitative (Why?)
- Quantitative (What?)

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- Interviews
- User observation

Example

- Watch how your friend uses an App. Do they pause, backtrack, or hesitate?

Quantitative (What?)

- Surveys
- Analytics

Example

- 80% of users stop at the payment page in an e-commerce app.

Why UX Research Matters?

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- Avoids guessing
- Uncovers real pain points
- Builds empathy
- Saves time in design
- Leads to better solutions

What is an Empathy Map?

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Visual tool to capture user mindset:

Scenario: A teen designing a food delivery app wants to understand their users' needs and pain points.

What is a User Persona?

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A fictional but realistic user based on patterns from research.

Includes:

- Name, age, photo
- Quote
- Needs & Goals
- Pain Points

What is the Define Stage?

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After research, make sense of it all.

- Look for patterns and frustrations
- Identify one clear problem to solve
- Focus on what's important and realistic

POV (Point of View) Statement

A format to turn insight into a design challenge:

Example

- [User] needs a way to [do something] because [reason].
- A [gym beginner] needs a way to [follow simple workout routines] because [they don't know how to structure their training.]

"How Might We..." Questions

Turn problems into creative prompts.

Example

- how might we help [user] [achieve a goal] despite [challenge]?
- how might we help [gym beginners] [start working out confidently] despite [having little knowledge about exercise routines]?

Summary

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- UX research helps us understand users
- Empathy Maps organize our findings
- Personas make users real
- The Define stage creates clear design direction
- "How Might We" helps move into ideation

Task

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- Interview (or reflect on yourself)
- Create an Empathy Map
- Build a User Persona
- Write a POV Statement
- Use it for your project